

Critical Writing

	Description	Analysis	Evaluation
Question words	Who, what, where, when, how much (quantity)?	How, why, what if?	So what, what next, to what extent?
To write about	Facts, statistics, definitions, reporting.	Relationship between parts: causes, comparisons, arguments, justifications.	Significance, consequences, judgements according to a standard.
Operation	Reports what is there.	Breaks the whole into parts, shows how they connect, or tests one part against another to build or undermine a claim.	Considers whole picture. Weights parts against specific criteria to give verdict on worth, effectiveness, importance.
Function	Background and context.	Explain how a claim holds together or why something occurs.	Judges why something matters and states wider implication.
Required output	Accurate factual statement.	Reasoned claim supported by logic.	A verdict that names its criteria: effective at <i>what</i> ? Better than <i>what</i> ? Not just an opinion.